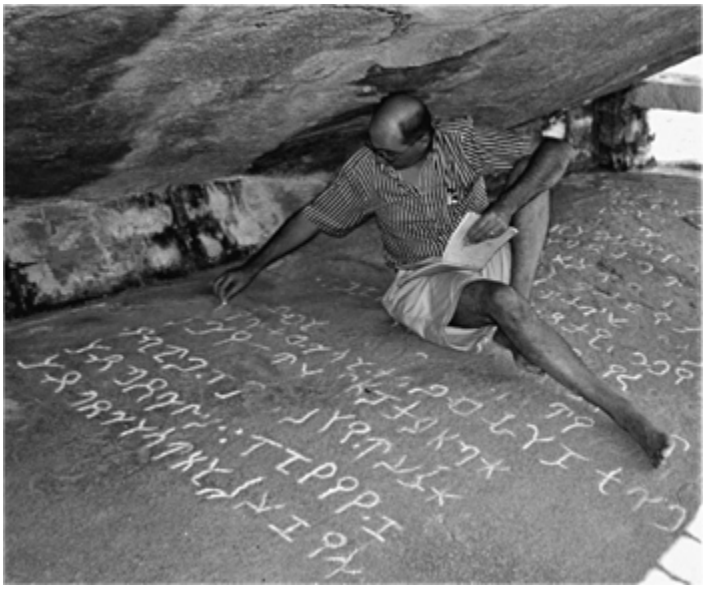
that this was as far as Ashoka’s empire extended. However, in 1892 Benjamin Rice made what he always considered to be his most important contribution to Indian history when he came across three Ashokan MREs while exploring in the Chitaldurga District of what is now Karnataka but was then part of Mysore State. Two were inscribed on boulders near the village of Siddapura, some 50 kilometres south of Bellary (Ballari), and the third on a hilltop a short distance to the north.



The Ashokan Minor Rock Edict at Siddapura, discovered by Benjamin Rice in 1892, here showing the eminent epigraphist Professor Harry Falk chalking in the letters.